

Phishing Awareness Training for Interns

Welcome to the team! Understanding cybersecurity is crucial for protecting yourself and our organization. This training will equip you with the knowledge to recognize and prevent phishing attacks.





What is Phishing?

A Digital Deception

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick you into **revealing sensitive information** or clicking harmful links.



The Attacker's Goal

The most common objective is to steal credentials (passwords), financial data, or install malicious software (malware) on your device.

The Global Threat

Phishing remains the single most common entry point for successful breaches, cited by the FBI as the **#1 cause of security incidents** worldwide.

How to Recognize Phishing Emails

Urgency & Threats

Watch for language that creates panic or urgency, such as: "Immediate action required" or "Your account will be suspended in 24 hours!"

Suspicious Sender

Carefully check the sender's email address. It may be spoofed, display the correct name but an odd domain, or be one letter off (e.g., @micros0ft.com).

Unexpected Links/Attachments

Be extremely cautious of unexpected files or links, even if the email appears to come from a known colleague.

Quality Control Issues

Poor grammar, numerous spelling mistakes, and inconsistent formatting are common red flags in mass-produced phishing attempts.



Fake Websites & Social Engineering Tactics

Phishing goes beyond email. Attackers use elaborate strategies to mimic trusted entities.



Spotting Fake Websites

Phishers create near-identical copies of legitimate login pages. Always check the URL in the address bar for the correct company domain before entering credentials.



Hover Before Clicking

On any link, hover your mouse over it (don't click!) to see the actual destination URL appear in the corner of your browser or email client. If it looks suspicious, don't click.



Social Engineering

This tactic exploits human psychology. Attackers pretend to be IT support, a senior executive, or an HR representative to bypass technical defenses and manipulate you.



Exploiting Emotions

Attackers exploit powerful emotions—trust, urgency, fear, or curiosity—to rush you into making a mistake without thinking.

Best Practices to Avoid Phishing

Never Click: The Golden Rule

Do not click links, open attachments, or download files from unknown or suspicious emails. If in doubt, assume it is malicious.

Verify Through Known Channels

If you receive an urgent request (e.g., to transfer money or change a password) from your "boss," call them directly or use a known internal chat channel to verify the request. **Do not reply to the suspicious email.**

Enable Strong Defenses

Use strong, unique passwords for all accounts and ensure Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is enabled wherever possible. MFA is an essential layer of protection.

Report Immediately

If you receive an email you suspect is phishing, report it immediately to the security team using the designated company reporting tool. Timely reporting protects everyone.

Real-World Consequences: When Phishing Succeeds

Phishing attacks are not theoretical; they cause massive financial, reputational, and legal damage to organizations globally.

Financial Loss

A major bank recently lost **\$10 Million** due to a sophisticated CEO impersonation email scam (Business Email Compromise or BEC).

Ransomware & Downtime

A significant 2024 healthcare provider attack started with a single phishing email, leading to system downtime, encrypted data, and massive recovery costs.

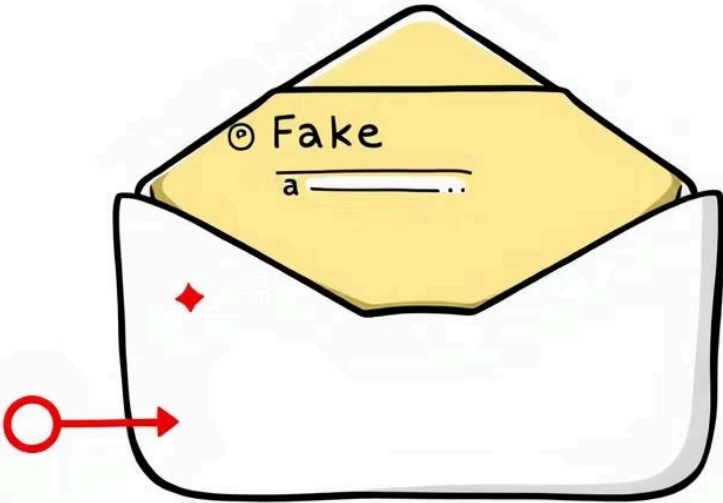
Data Breaches

Data breaches at global firms have often been traced back to employees entering their login credentials into **fake login pages** disguised as internal systems.

- ❏ These incidents highlight why security is everyone's responsibility—a single mistake can have organizational consequences.

Dissecting a Phishing Email

Here is a visual breakdown of common red flags to look for in a typical phishing attempt, requiring immediate attention.



🚩 Red Flag Summary

- Generic greeting ("Dear User") instead of your name.
- Suspicious sender domain (e.g., `support@appl3.com`).
- Subject line creating high pressure or urgency.

🔍 Action Steps

- Hover over the "Click Here" button—the link URL does not match the expected domain.
- The email requests personal information or payment details.
- Note the poor design quality or unusual layout.

Interactive Quiz: Spot the Phish!

Test your knowledge with these scenarios. Choose the correct action for each situation.

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Question 1: The Urgent Request

You get an email from "Finance Dept" asking you to click a link to update payroll info immediately or risk missing your next paycheck. Is this safe?

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Question 2: The Spoofed Link

You receive a notification from your company's "Help Desk" asking you to reset your password. When you hover over the link, it shows a strange domain. What should you do?

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Question 3: Suspicious Attachment

A vendor sends an unexpected email with a ZIP file labeled "Invoice_Q3." You were not expecting this document. How can you verify this request?

(Answers are available from your supervisor or IT security team.)

Summary: Stay Vigilant, Stay Safe



Phishing Evolves

Attackers are constantly refining their techniques. Your personal awareness is the most critical layer of defense against these evolving threats.



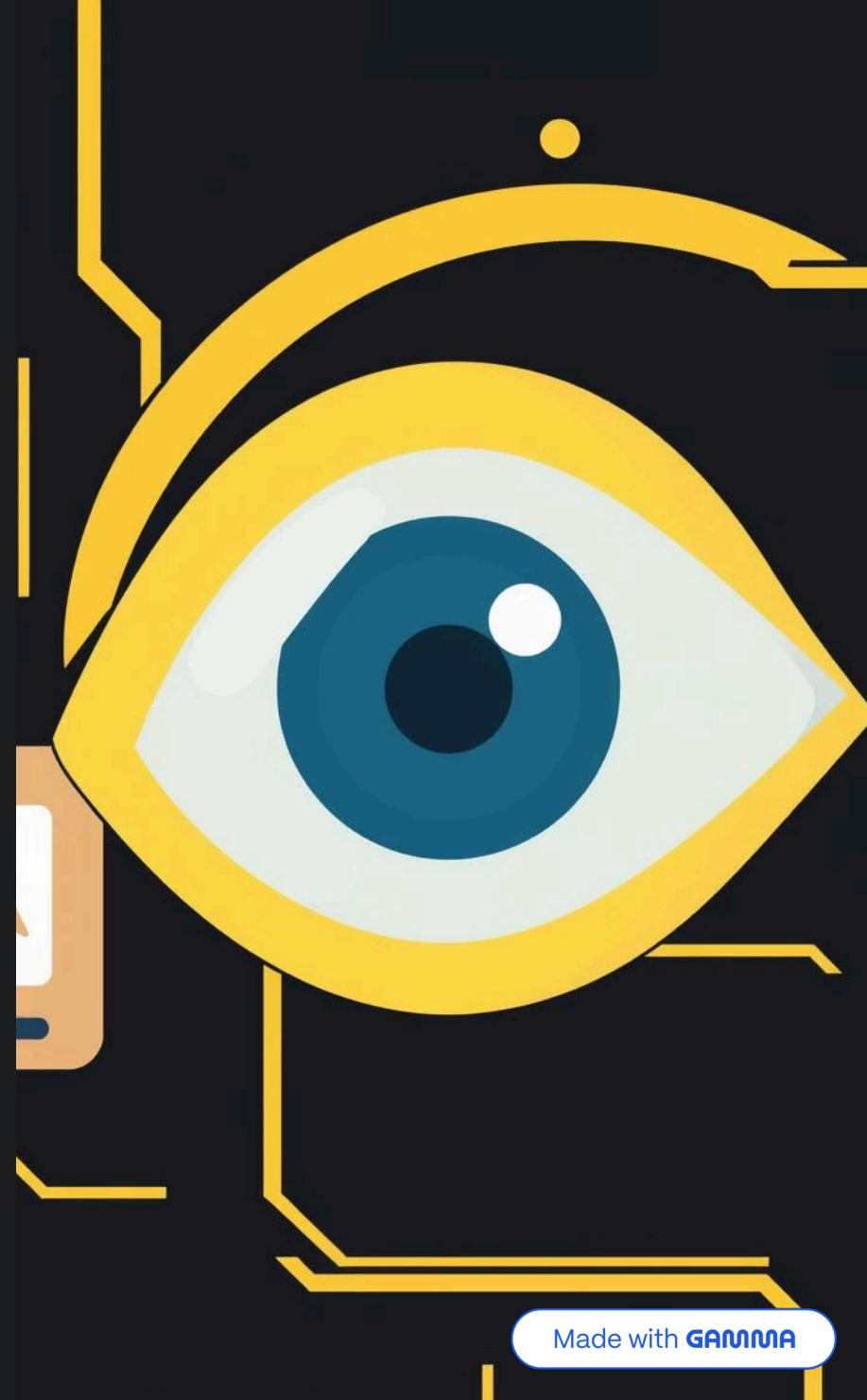
Pause and Think

Make it a habit to pause for five seconds before clicking any link or sharing information, especially if the email creates a sense of pressure.



Report Instantly

Utilize company tools to report anything suspicious without hesitation. Reporting helps protect the entire organization from potential breaches.



Thank You! Questions & Resources



Your Role in Security

- For further information and up-to-date threat alerts, visit the [company security portal](#) or contact IT support at any time.
- Remember: Your secure actions protect not only your data but the integrity and reputation of the entire organization.
- Stay curious, stay cautious, and help us build a secure, trust-worthy workplace!

Contact IT Support

Security Portal